# PRACTICAL – 2

## Launch and Connect to an Amazon EC2 Instance

**Aim:** To create an Amazon EC2 virtual machine in AWS and connect to it using the browser-based terminal or a remote desktop client.

## A. Create a Linux EC2 instance

**1.** Sign in to the AWS Management Console and open **EC2**. Select the required AWS Region (the screenshots use Asia Pacific – Sydney).

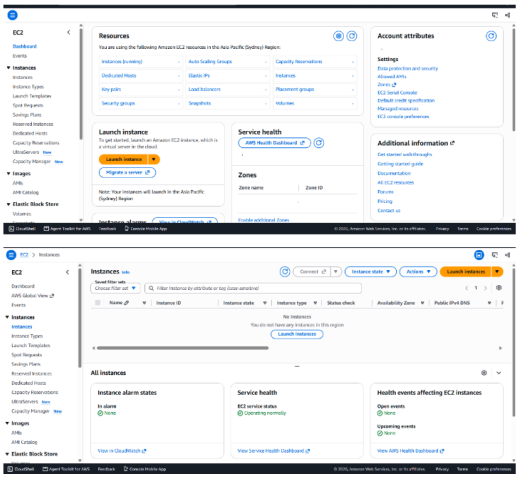
**2.** Choose **Instances** → **Launch instances** and enter an instance name.

**3.** Select an Amazon Machine Image such as **Amazon Linux 2023** and choose an eligible instance type (for example, t3.micro).

**4.** Create or select a key pair. Keep the private key file (.pem) safe; never share or upload it publicly.

**5.** Configure the network and security group. Allow only the required inbound access (SSH, TCP port 22, for Linux).

**6.** Set the storage size (the example uses 8 GiB), review the summary, and choose **Launch instance**.

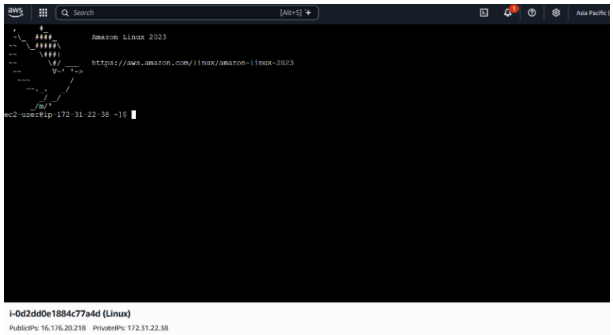


## B. Connect to the Linux instance

**1.** Wait until the instance state is **Running** and status checks pass.

**2.** Select the instance and click **Connect**. Choose **EC2 Instance Connect** (browser-based) and click Connect.

**3.** A terminal opens. You can now run Linux commands on the EC2 virtual machine.



# PRACTICAL – 2 (CONTINUED)

## Create and Connect to a Windows EC2 Instance

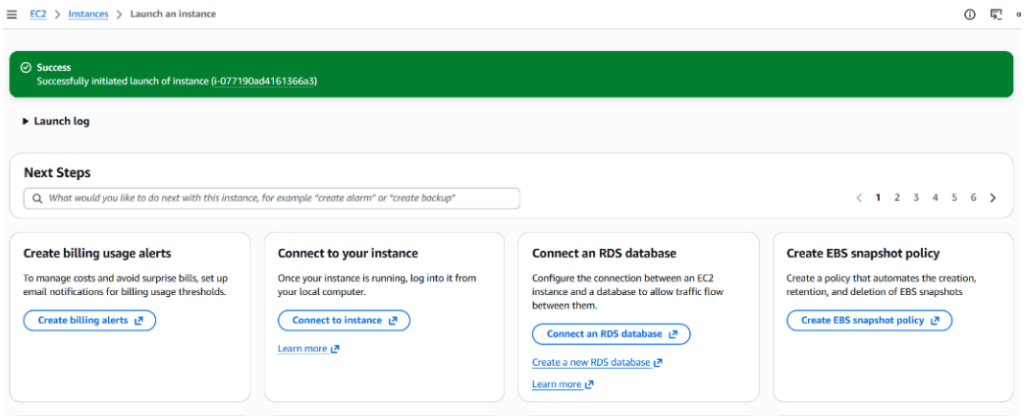
### C. Launch a Windows instance

**1.** From the EC2 dashboard, choose **Launch instances** and enter a name for the Windows virtual machine.

**2.** Under Application and OS Images, select a suitable **Windows Server** AMI. Choose an eligible instance type.

**3.** Create or select a key pair and save the private key securely. Configure the network and allow Remote Desktop access (TCP port 3389) only from your trusted IP address.

**4.** Review storage and other settings, then click **Launch instance**. Wait until the instance is running and its status checks pass.



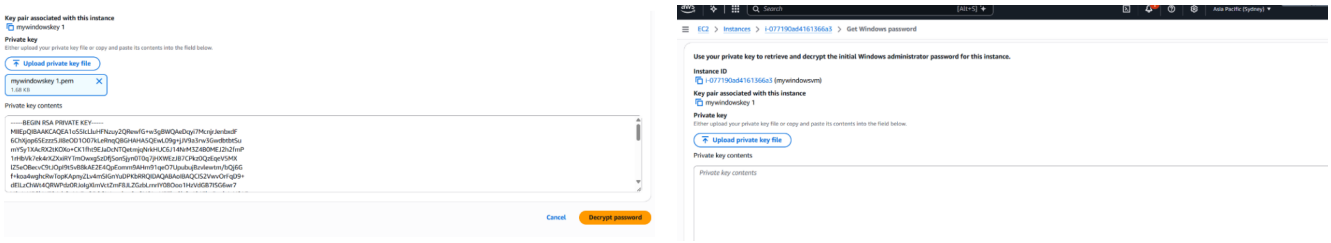

### D. Retrieve the Windows password and connect

**1.** Select the Windows instance and choose **Connect** → **RDP client**.

**2.** Choose **Get password**. Upload the private key file associated with the instance, then select **Decrypt password**.

**3.** Copy the generated Administrator password. Keep it private and do not include it in screenshots or reports.

**4.** Open Remote Desktop Connection on your computer. Enter the instance's public IPv4 address and username **Administrator**, then connect using the decrypted password.




**Note:** The screenshots illustrate the AWS connection workflow. Actual instance IDs, public IP addresses, usernames and passwords will differ.

# PRACTICAL – 2 (CONTINUED)

## Terminate the EC2 Instance and Result

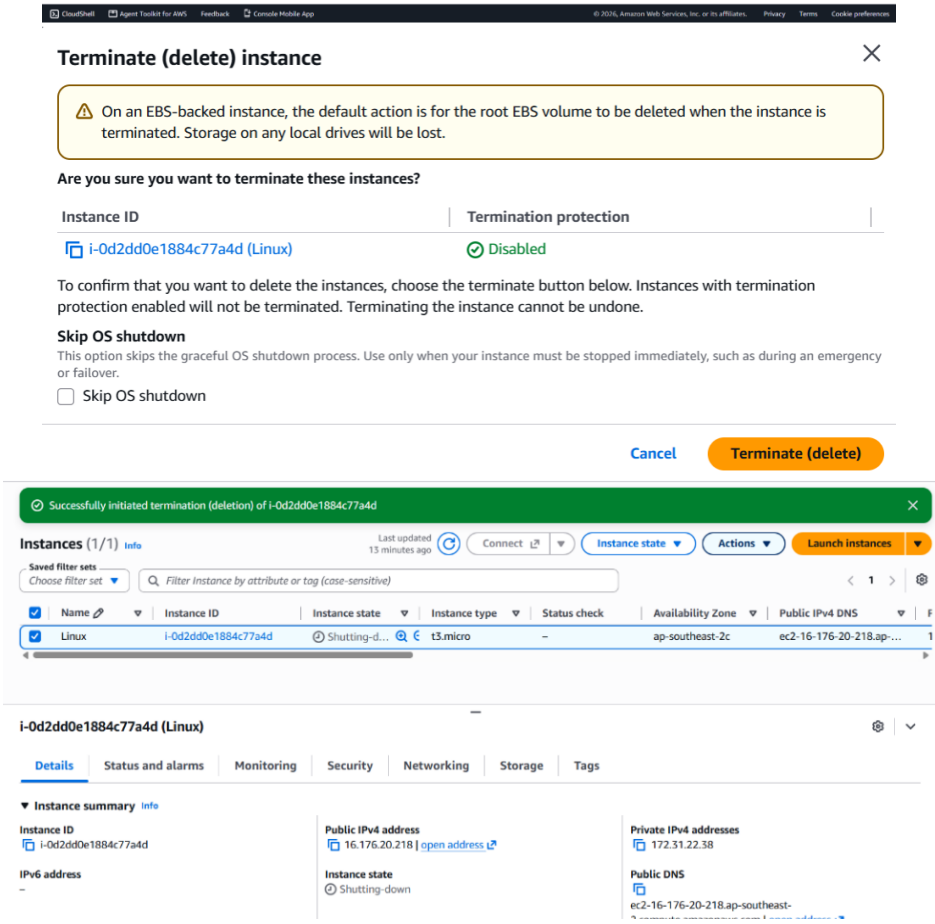
### E. Terminate (delete) an EC2 instance

**1.** Open **EC2** → **Instances** and select the instance that is no longer required.

**2.** Choose **Instance state** → **Terminate instance** (or the Terminate option under Actions).

**3.** Read the warning carefully. Termination cannot be undone and data on instance-store/local drives is lost. Check whether the root EBS volume will be deleted.

**4.** Confirm by choosing **Terminate**. Wait until the instance state changes from shutting-down to terminated.




## Result

Successfully launched Linux and Windows EC2 instances, connected to them using the appropriate connection methods, and terminated the instance when the practical was completed.

**Precautions:** Use a strong key pair, restrict SSH/RDP access to trusted IP addresses, never share private keys or passwords, and terminate unused instances to avoid unnecessary AWS charges.